Policy Proposal & Video Blog Script

Health Policy and Systems Researcher Perspective | India
Proposed focus: Strengthening prevention and control of hypertension through primary health care

Addressed to the Hon’ble Minister of Health

Hon’ble Minister, I am presenting a health policy and systems research proposal to strengthen hypertension prevention, early detection, treatment and long-term control in India. Hypertension is a major public-health challenge because it often has no obvious symptoms while increasing the risk of heart disease, stroke and kidney disease. A stronger primary-health-care response can improve population health while supporting Universal Health Coverage (UHC).

Evidence-informed policy options

No.	Policy option	Proposed action
1	Routine screening at primary-care level	Make blood-pressure measurement a routine part of adult primary-care visits and community outreach, with clear referral and follow-up pathways for people with elevated readings.
2	Strengthen continuity of care	Use standard treatment protocols, reliable medicine availability, patient registers and follow-up systems so diagnosed patients can remain on treatment and be monitored over time.
3	Community prevention	Combine primary-care services with community education on salt reduction, physical activity, healthy diet, tobacco avoidance and appropriate weight management, using locally understandable messages.
4	Use data for improvement	Develop simple dashboards and facility-level indicators to monitor screening, treatment initiation, medicine availability, follow-up and blood-pressure control, while protecting patient confidentiality.

Knowledge production and translation

As a health systems researcher, I would generate context-specific evidence using routine health information data, facility assessments, patient and provider interviews, community consultations, and implementation research. Quantitative indicators would show where gaps occur, while qualitative evidence would explain why they occur. I would translate findings into a short policy brief, an implementation dashboard, stakeholder workshops and simple communication materials for communities. The aim is to move from evidence to action

rather than producing research that remains only in academic settings.

Challenges and ways to overcome them

- Limited or inconsistent data: improve routine data quality through simple reporting standards, staff training and periodic data-quality checks.
- Medicine and workforce constraints: use realistic phased implementation, strengthen supply-chain monitoring and prioritise high-burden facilities.
- Low adherence and follow-up: use reminder systems, counselling and community-based follow-up where appropriate.
- Institutional resistance: involve policymakers, providers and communities early, communicate benefits clearly, and use pilot projects to demonstrate feasibility.

UHC and Sustainable Development Goals

This proposal supports SDG 3, particularly the goal of reducing premature mortality from non-communicable diseases, and contributes to UHC by improving access to essential prevention, diagnosis and treatment through primary health care. Equity should remain central so that rural, low-income and underserved populations are not left behind.

Closing message for the video

Minister, my proposal is not simply to screen more people; it is to build a system that can detect hypertension, start appropriate care, maintain medicine availability, support patients and learn from its own data. I recommend starting with a phased implementation in selected high-burden districts, evaluating the results, and scaling approaches that demonstrate effectiveness, feasibility and equity. As a health policy and systems researcher, my role is to connect credible evidence with practical decisions and to work with communities and institutions so that evidence leads to measurable health improvement.

Suggested references for the recorded submission

• World Health Organization. Global report on hypertension: The race against a silent killer. WHO, 2023.

• World Health Organization. HEARTS: Technical package for cardiovascular disease management in primary health care. WHO.

• United Nations. Sustainable Development Goal 3: Good Health and Well-being.

• World Health Organization. Universal Health Coverage (UHC) fact sheet and related guidance.

Submission note: The Coursera assignment specifically requests a recorded video blog. This PDF is formatted as the complete script/proposal to use for recording; the platform may not accept a PDF as a substitute for the required video.